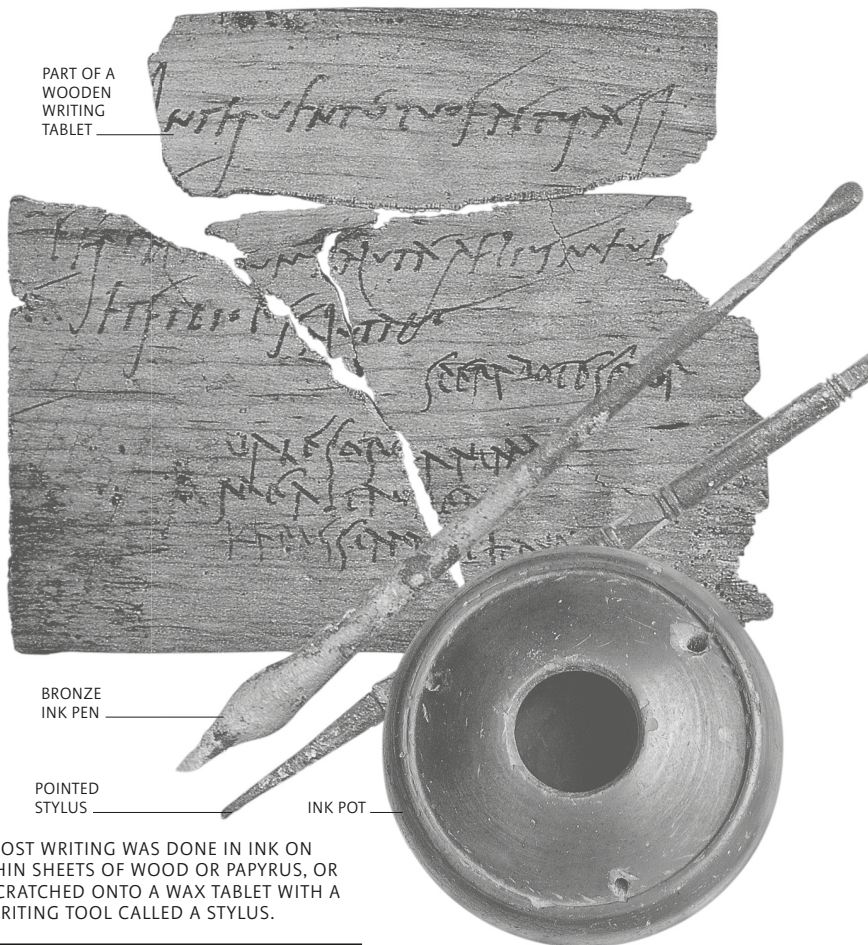


PART OF A
WOODEN
WRITING
TABLET

MOST WRITING WAS DONE IN INK ON THIN SHEETS OF WOOD OR PAPYRUS, OR SCRATCHED ONTO A WAX TABLET WITH A WRITING TOOL CALLED A STYLUS.

a room hired by a teacher at the back of a shop with just a curtain to separate the shoppers from the scholars.

School days

Boys usually began school at the age of 7. In Rome, the school day started early, usually just after dawn. Preschool children sat on wooden stools

facing the teacher, who was perched in a high chair. Known as a *litterator*, the teacher taught the students how to read and write letters, as well as how to do simple math. Children learned by copying and reciting letters, sentences, and numbers over and over again. At age 10 or 11, some boys from rich families went to elementary school. Girls